From Prompts to AI Workflows

Bring a real decision. Leave with a workflow you'll actually reuse.

✏️ **This workbook belongs to** ______________________________

👤 **Facilitated by** — Dileep Karri

💻 **You'll need** — a laptop, Claude open, and one real decision + dataset

🎯 **You'll leave with** — two working prompts, a multi-tool routine, and a personal playbook

START HERE

Before You Begin

This is a working session, not a lecture. Every part has something to **do** and space to write. Pick **one real decision** you actually face — you'll run it through every workflow today, so the output is real, not a toy. Fill this in now; you'll reuse it on every page.

WORKSHEET 0 — YOUR WORKING EXAMPLE

The decision you'll carry through this workbook

The decision I face: ____________________

The number that tells me it worked: ____________________

Scope (time / segment / place): ____________________

Data I have access to: ____________________

If you can't fill a line yet — good. The first workflow will help you find it.

The one idea behind today

A single prompt gives you an *answer*. A workflow gives you a **reliable outcome** — same input quality, same output quality, every time. You don't need to become an AI expert. You need one good prompt and the judgment to know when to go deeper.

PART 1 · WARM-UP

Prompt vs Workflow

You upload a spreadsheet, type *"analyze this and tell me what you find,"* and get back a generic chart and no decision. The reason: you never told it what decision you're making — and you may not know how to frame it yet. The fix isn't a harder prompt; it's making the AI ask *you* the right questions first.

THE DOCTOR ANALOGY

> *"Analyze this data" is walking into a doctor's office and saying "fix me." A bad doctor guesses; a good doctor takes your history first. The skill isn't asking better questions — it's hiring something that asks them for you.*

EXERCISE 1 — 2 MINUTES

Catch your own bad prompt

A vague AI request you've actually typed (be honest):

Now rewrite it naming the decision, the metric, and the scope:

PART 2 · LAB 1

The Analyst Prompt

One prompt turns Claude into a senior analyst that interviews you first, waits, and only then delivers a structured answer. The effort is hidden inside the prompt, not loaded onto you. This is your everyday tool.

COPY THIS EXACTLY

```
You are a senior McKinsey-style analyst. I am going to give you some data
(or describe a decision). Do NOT analyze anything yet.

FIRST, interview me. Ask me up to 6 sharp clarifying questions, in one batch,
to understand:
- The decision I'm actually trying to make
- What a good outcome looks like (the metric that matters)
- The scope (time period, segment, geography)
- What I already know and what data I have
- Any constraints or assumptions you should respect

WAIT for my answers.

THEN deliver your analysis in this structure:
```

```
1. Executive Summary - the answer and why, in 5 lines
2. What the Data Shows - key findings with the numbers behind them
3. What This Means - implications and risks
4. Recommendation - one clear action, expected impact, main risk, first step
5. What I'm Not Sure About - weakest assumptions and what would change it

Keep it crisp. No filler. Plain language a busy executive understands.
```

DO THIS NOW

- [ ] Open Claude and upload your real dataset (CSV or Excel).
- [ ] Paste the Analyst Prompt above — send it.
- [ ] Answer the questions it asks back (imperfect answers are fine).
- [ ] Read the 5-part output, then scroll to “What I'm Not Sure About.”

WORKSHEET 1 — CAPTURE THE INTERVIEW

What Claude asked you back

The sharpest 2–3 questions it asked (these reveal what you hadn't thought about):

From section 5 — the weakest assumption it admitted to:

WHY IT WORKS

> *“Analyze this data” is throwing ingredients in a pan and hoping. This prompt is a recipe card — same dish, every cook, every time. Section 5 is the AI's confession box: most people never ask what it's unsure about, so it never tells them. This makes it mandatory.*

REFLECT — 1 MINUTE

How was this different from a normal prompt?

PART 3 · LAB 2

ACR — For When It Really Matters

The Analyst Prompt is the automatic car. ACR is manual transmission — more effort, full control — for when serious money, people, or deadlines are involved, or someone will challenge your numbers in a room. Three steps, and **you** drive each one.

A = Ask — you frame it

WORKSHEET 2A — FRAME YOUR OWN ASK

Fill this for your real decision, then paste it into the template below

DECISION: ____________________

METRIC: ____________________

SCOPE: ____________________

CONTEXT: ____________________

THE ASK TEMPLATE

```
You are a business analyst helping me make a specific decision.

DECISION: [from your worksheet above]
METRIC:   [from your worksheet above]
SCOPE:    [from your worksheet above]
CONTEXT:  [from your worksheet above]

Return:
1. A single, precise analysis question
2. Three sub-questions that support it
3. The data fields I need
4. What a strong answer looks like vs a weak one
```

THE RESTAURANT ANALOGY

> *"Bring me food" vs "grilled fish, no butter, lemon on the side, 20 minutes." Same kitchen, wildly different result. Here you write the questions — more work, more precision, more control.*

C = Check — make it argue against itself

RUN THIS ON THE ANSWER YOU JUST GOT

```
Review your previous analysis critically.

1. What are the 3 weakest assumptions you made?
2. What data would change your conclusion if it were different?
3. Rate your confidence: High / Medium / Low for each insight
4. What did you NOT consider that might matter?
5. If someone argued against your conclusion, what's their strongest point?
```

If it rates everything "High," push back: *"Be more honest. What are you least sure about and why?"*

WORKSHEET 2C — THE CRACKS IT FOUND

The weakest assumptions the Check surfaced

R = Recommend — turn it into an action

RUN THIS LAST

```
Based on the analysis and the self-critique, create an
executive recommendation.

RECOMMENDED ACTION: [One sentence. What should we do?]
WHY NOW:            [2-3 sentences. Why this, why now?]
EXPECTED IMPACT:    [Metric + estimated range]
MAIN RISK:          [What could go wrong + mitigation]
NEXT STEP:          [One concrete action for the next 48 hours]

Under 200 words. No jargon. Understandable in 30 seconds.
```

WORKSHEET 2R — YOUR RECOMMENDATION

Write the final call in your own words (the bar: could you forward this to your manager now?)

ACTION: ______________________

WHY NOW: ______________________

IMPACT: ______________________

MAIN RISK: ______________________

NEXT STEP (48h): ______________________

Which one do I use? — tick to decide

- ☐ Serious money, people, or deadlines are on the line
- ☐ I need to audit every step, not trust one output
- ☐ I'll run this repeatedly and want a fixed, teachable process

Any box ticked → use **ACR**. None → the **Analyst Prompt** is enough. *Simple prompt for most days. ACR for the day it really matters.*

PART 4 · LAB 3

The Multi-Tool Workflow

No single tool is best at everything. Assemble a team of specialists. Order is fixed: decorate the house before buying furniture before arranging the room.

🎨 **Designer** Gemini	→	🔍 **Researcher** Perplexity	→	🧠 **Analyst** NotebookLM

RUN IT ON YOUR OWN BRAND / PROBLEM

- ☐ **Step 1 — Gemini.** Paste your site URL and the prompt below; save the style guide.

```
"Look at this website - [URL]. Analyse the brand's design language,
colour palette, typography, tone of voice, and overall personality.
Summarise it as a style guide I can reuse."
```

- [ ] **Step 2 — Perplexity.** Research your space; copy the full output and the source links.

```
"I run [your business - URL]. Research my competitors, market trends,
pricing, and customer pain points. Summarise with sources."
```

- [ ] **Step 3 — NotebookLM.** New notebook; add your site, the research, and the style guide as sources (paste as Note → convert to Source).
- [ ] **Step 4 — configure the voice.** The step everyone skips. Fill the worksheet, then paste it into Settings / Configure.

WORKSHEET 3 — YOUR NOTEBOOKLM BRIEFING

Fill the two blanks, then paste the whole block into NotebookLM

YOUR BRAND NAME: ______________________

One-line description: ______________________

NOTEBOOKLM CONFIGURATION PROMPT

```
ROLE
You are a strategy consultant for [YOUR BRAND NAME],
a [one-line description].
You are structured, data-driven, and give clear recommendations.

RULES
- Only use the sources provided. Do not make things up.
- Use numbers and citations wherever possible.
- Keep language crisp. Short paragraphs, clear headings, no filler.
- If information is missing, say so and suggest what data to collect.
- When making slides, follow the brand design language from the sources.

WHEN I ASK FOR AN ANALYSIS, STRUCTURE IT AS:
1. Executive Summary - what to do and why (10 lines max)
2. Market Map - how the market is segmented and where the money is
3. Competitor Landscape - who competes and how they're positioned
4. Customer Insights - what customers want and what frustrates them
5. Recommendations - 2-3 options ranked by priority with reasons
```

```
6. Scoring Table - rate each option (1-5): market size, brand fit,
   differentiation, profitability, speed to launch
7. Open Questions - what still needs answers before deciding
```

- [ ] **Step 5 — ask in order.** “Give me a full analysis” → “rank options in a table” → “make a deck in our brand style” → “risks of Option X” → “what are customers saying.”
- [ ] **Step 6 — export.** Into Slides / Docs; reapply the Step 1 brand guide.

WORKSHEET 3B — MAP YOUR PROBLEM TO THE FRAMEWORK

The pattern works for anything — prove it on your own

YOUR PROBLEM	🎨 DESIGNER STEP	🔍 RESEARCHER STEP	🧠 ANALYST STEP

Days of work into roughly 30–45 minutes — that's the line you'll repeat to a colleague.

PART 5 · LAB 4

Connectors — Remove the Middleman

Right now you are the courier: download from Drive, upload to the AI, rebuild in Slides, copy-paste between tabs. A connector lets the AI reach into an app directly. Connect once, works everywhere — a universal adapter for AI.

CONNECT EXACTLY ONE THING NOW

- [ ] **Claude:** Tools → Add Connectors → pick an app (e.g. Google Drive) → Connect → authenticate.
- [ ] **ChatGPT (paid):** Settings → Connectors → pick the app → Connect → authenticate.
- [ ] Test it: *“Read my latest file in Google Drive and summarise the key decisions.”*

WORKSHEET 4 — YOUR FIRST CONNECTOR

No download, no upload, no copy-paste — what happened?

App I connected: ____________________

What it did for me: ____________________

⚠️ Safety — tick each before you trust it with real work

- ☐ **Allow Once, not Always** — start with the one-time grant; widen later. A day pass, not a permanent key.
- ☐ **Verify before you act** — read AI-written emails/messages before sending. Never auto-send.
- ☐ **Mind the tier** — free plans may train on your data; don't connect confidential data on free tiers.

PART 6 · MAKE IT STICK

Build Your Personal Playbook

A workflow you don't commit to is just notes. Fill this in before you leave the room — this is the page you'll actually come back to.

WORKSHEET 5 — YOUR PLAYBOOK

From today → this week

My everyday move: ____________________

(Replace "analyze this data" with the Analyst Prompt — the single highest-value habit change.)

When I'll switch to ACR: ____________________

The real decision I'll run this on: ____________________

By when: ____________________

Signed: ____________________

Today's checklist

- ✔ Defined a real decision (Worksheet 0)
- ✔ Ran the Analyst Prompt on real data and read its self-doubt
- ✔ Drove a full ACR cycle: Ask → Check → Recommend
- ✔ Briefed and queried a NotebookLM consultant; mapped my own problem
- ✔ Connected one app and tested it safely
- ✔ Wrote my playbook and committed to one decision this week

KEEP THIS

Quick Reference Card

Everyday — The Analyst Prompt

```
You are a senior McKinsey-style analyst. Do NOT analyze yet.
FIRST interview me (up to 6 questions): decision, success metric,
scope, what I know/have, constraints. WAIT for answers.
THEN: 1) Exec Summary 2) What the data shows 3) What it means
4) Recommendation (action, impact, risk, next step)
5) What I'm not sure about. Crisp, plain language.
```

Advanced — ACR

```
ASK    -> DECISION / METRIC / SCOPE / CONTEXT
CHECK  -> 3 weakest assumptions? what would change it?
          confidence per insight? what's missing? counter-argument?
RECOMMEND -> ACTION / WHY NOW / IMPACT / RISK / NEXT STEP
```

The whole workbook in one line, from Dileep: you don't need to become an AI expert — you need one good prompt and the judgment to know when to go deeper. Simple prompt for most days. ACR for the day it really matters.